

Fusate-250 Tablet

Composition: Each film-coated tablet contains Sodium fusidate 250mg

Description: A white to off white oblong shaped film coated tablet.

Pharmacodynamic:

Fusate tablet exerts antibacterial activity against a number of gram-positive organisms. Staphylococci, including the strains resistant to penicillin or to other antibiotics, are particularly susceptible to sodium fusidate.

Pharmacokinetic:

Blood levels are cumulative, reaching concentrations of 20-35 micrograms/ml after oral administrations of 250mg twice daily for seven days and 50-100 micrograms/ml after oral administrations of 500mg three times daily for three to four days.

Fusate Tablet is widely distributed. It is excreted mainly in the bile, little or none being excreted in the urine.

Indications:

Staphylococcal infections e.g. osteomyelitis, septicaemia, endocarditis, cystic fibrosis, pneumonia, cellulitis, surgical and traumatic wound infections.

Dosage and administration:

Adults: 2 tablets 3 times daily

Skin and soft tissue infections: One 250mg tablet twice daily.

Doses may be doubled in severe cases.

Route of administration:

Oral administration

Contraindication:

Contraindicated in patients with known hypersensitivity to fusidic acid and its salts.

Side effects:

In some instances, reversible jaundice has been reported particularly in the young and elderly. Fusate should be withdrawn if jaundice persists.

Reported reactions are gastrointestinal upsets and rarely, skin rashes and other allergic reactions including anaphylaxis.

Isolated cases of haematological abnormalities which can affect the 3 blood cell lines but mainly white blood cells e.g. bone marrow depression, neutropenia, granulocytopenia, agranulocytosis and pancytopenia have been reported. Depressive effects on the platelets and red blood cells, thrombocytopenia and various anaemias have been reported less often especially with treatment of more than 15 days.

Acute renal failure has been described in patients with jaundice, particularly in the presence of other factors predisposing to renal failure.

Precautions:

Caution should be exercised with other antibiotics which have similar biliary excretion pathways e.g. lincomycin and rifampicin. When Fusate is administered for prolonged

periods and in patients with liver dysfunction, periodic liver function tests should be carried out when high oral doses are used.

The use of drugs that are CYP-3A4 biotransformed in combination with Fusate should be avoided.

Patients should be closely clinically monitored if Fusate is given systemically with HMG-CoA reductase inhibitors.

Drug interaction:

Specific pathways of metabolism in the liver are not known, however an interaction with drugs being CYP-3A4 biotransformed can be suspected. Concomitant administration with oral anticoagulants such as coumarin derivatives or anticoagulants with similar actions may increase the plasma concentration of these agents enhancing the anticoagulant effect.

Concomitant administration with HMG-CoA reductase inhibitors such as statins may cause increased plasma concentrations of both agents and rare cases of rhabdomyolysis have been reported for this combination. Patients on this combination should be closely clinically monitored.

Administration with ciclosporin has been reported to cause increased plasma concentration of ciclosporin.

Pregnancy and lactation:

There is inadequate evidence of safety in human pregnancy. Animal studies and many years of clinical experience have suggested that fusidic acid is devoid of teratogenic effects. It passes the placenta and should be avoided during the 3rd trimester of pregnancy due to the theoretical risk of kernicterus.

Concentrations of fusidic acid have been found in breast milk. Caution is therefore required when fusidic acid is used in mothers who wish to breast feed.

Overdosage:

Treatment should be restricted to symptomatic and supportive measures. Dialysis is of no benefit as the drug is not significantly dialyzed.

Storage:

Store in a dry place below 30°C.

Presentation:

Blisters of 10 tablets. Box of 20, 100 and 500 tablets.

Manufactured by:

Noripharma Sdn. Bhd. (792633-A)

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